GENERAL EDUCATION

Mission

In line with the University's mission, the General Education program aims to improve students' awareness and intellectual capacity to address the complex and diverse issues and challenges confronting the world around them, and to empower them to thoughtfully consider those issues in their personal and professional decisions and choices.

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of the General Education Program, students will demonstrate:

- Critical thinking in evaluating scholarly sources and arguments;
- Information literacy and skills in applying modern computing tools and techniques;
- Ability to make informed decisions based on ethical principles and reasoning;
- Aptitude for aspiring to continuous improvement and lifelong learning.

Domains of Knowledge

Every RHU student must take 30–33 credit hours of general education courses, distributed across six domains described below. Twenty-one mandatory credits are selected from domains 1, 4, 5, and 6, and 9-12 elective credit hours are selected from domains 2 and 3:

Domain		Credits	Courses
1	Communication Competency*	8	ENGL 210: English Composition and Rhetoric ENGL 217: Professional English Communication ARAB 212**:** Arabic Language and Communication
2	Humanities/Fine Arts	3-6	Selected from an approved list
3	Social Sciences/Culture	6	Selected from an approved list
4	Natural Sciences and Technology	6	Per major requirement*
5	Quantitative Reasoning	3	Per major requirement*
6	Community and Sustainability	4	Per major requirement*

* Refer to the introductory section of the college of interest for a description of courses specific to domains 4, 5, and 6.

Domain Specific Courses

Communication Courses

ARAB 212	Arabic Language & Communication	2(2,0)
This course helps students develop their ability to communicate effectively in standard Arabic. It provides students with the necessary Arabic communication skills they may need for their future jobs. Specifically, students learn how to write and orally present different forms of workplace documents in Arabic.		

ENGL 210	English Composition and Rhetoric	3(3,0)
This course reviews the fundamentals of good academic writing in English, teaches essay writing essentials and research skills in two rhetorical modes (persuasion and argumentation), and provides practice in writing essays in these modes, research papers, and oral presentations. **Prerequisite**: ENGL 101 or TOEFL 550+ (paper) or 80+ (computer).		

ENGL 217	Professional English Communication	3(3,0)
This course is designed to help students develop effective professional communication skills, both orally and in writing. In this course, students learn how to write emails, memos, letters, proposals, reports, and other forms of employment correspondence. In addition, this course helps students sharpen their presentation skills. Broadly, this course enables students to behave professionally and effectively in their prospective jobs. **Prerequisite**: ENGL 210.		

Elective Courses

Description of the Courses that satisfy Domain 2 and 3 requirements is given below.

Humanities/Fine Arts

Descriptions of elective courses that may be chosen to satisfy the Humanities/Fine Arts domain are given below.

BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to contemporary business principles of ethics and social responsibility. Students learn to make ethical judgments about important issues they face daily by relating them to a framework of ethical principles, including utilitarianism, justice, moral rights, the ethics of care, and virtues and vices. Ethical dilemmas related to conflicts of interest, sustainability in business strategy, and corporate governance are among the issues discussed in this course. Prerequisite: Junior Standing.		

CMNS 360	Ethics in Communication	3(3,0)
This course explores the theoretical and practical ethical questions about communication in four contexts: interpersonal communication, workplace		

communication, communication within one's community and society, and mass and digital communication. Discussion of ethical theories in communication studies will provide a basis to explore case studies and contemporary communication dilemmas, heightening personal sensitivity to the underlying ethical implications of human communication. **Co-requisite:** ENGL 210.

CMNS 470	**Videography in Media**	**3(3,0)**
This course will explore the world of cinema, video shooting, and editing. Students will dive into the preproduction, production, and post-production phases. Throughout the course, students will be expected to complete assignments in shooting, editing, and creating different types of narratives. They will understand and learn how to shoot and handle different types of videos. Students will also apply these skills to create trailers, shoot interviews, and create an advertisement reel.		

CMNS 320	**Creative Nonfiction**	**3(3,0)**
This course teaches students rhetorical modes in short essays and journalism, including memoirs, reportage, and reflective essays. Students will practice a writing style focused on conciseness and clarity, deliver effective oral presentations, and read articles, essays, and other increasingly complex materials. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

CVLN 301	**Civilization Studies I**	**3(3,0)**
This course surveys key figures, movements, and texts in cultural studies from the birth of civilization through the Middle Ages. The concentration will be on the historical, political, religious, cultural, and institutional aspects during this period. Students will read, analyze, and interpret certain primary works to gain insight into the contexts in which they originated. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

CVLN 302	**Civilization Studies II**	**3(3,0)**
This course surveys some key figures, movements, and texts in cultural studies from the 14th through the 18th centuries. The concentration will be on the historical, political, religious, cultural, and institutional aspects during this period. Students will read, analyze, and interpret certain primary works to gain insight into the contexts in which they originated. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

CVLN 303	**Civilization Studies III**	**3(3,0)**
This course surveys some key figures, movements, and texts in cultural studies from the 19th century to the present. The concentration will be on the historical, political, religious, cultural, and institutional aspects during this period. Students will read, analyze, and interpret certain primary works to gain insight into the contexts in which they originated. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

CVLN 320	**Feminism Beyond Borders**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces students to feminism by exploring its historical development, major waves, and key issues. At its core, this course aims to challenge students' understanding of feminism and its relevance today. The course focuses on the		

intersection of feminism with other social justice movements, including race, class, and culture, to challenge universal or “one-size-fits-all” feminist narratives.

EDUC 201	**Fundamentals of Education**	**3(3,0)**
This course studies modern education principles and their application in elementary and secondary schools. It includes examinations and discussion of teaching procedures and techniques, as well as considerations of the historical, cultural, and societal views of schooling.		

EDUC 211	**Fundamentals of Special Education**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces Special Education, with a particular focus on current practices. Students are introduced to common learning disabilities and intervention programs, as well as a historical overview of the development of Special Education.		

EDUC 312	**Educational Philosophy**	**3(3,0)**
This course provides a survey of the development of thought on education by examining major philosophical writings in historical context. **Prerequisite**: EDUC 210.		

EDUC 360	**Children’s Literature**	**3(3,0)**
This course draws on the theoretical and practical aspects of the study of literature for children. Students develop a wide familiarity with children's books and understand how children's literature fits into the elementary school curriculum.		

EDUC 365	**Art Education**	**3(3,0)**
This course explores concepts in art, music, drama, and movement for young children. The methods cover various activities that develop children's physical-motor, social-emotional, and cognitive skills, providing conditions for creativity and aesthetic awareness.		

ENGL 214	**Introduction to English Poetry**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces first-year students to poets with intrinsic literary merits. In addition to broadening students’ understanding and appreciation of literature, the course's chief aim is to develop students’ critical thinking and analysis and to encourage original responses to literary expression through well-developed oral and written criticism. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 220	**Introduction to Literature**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces literature through fiction, poetry, and drama. It introduces students to the pleasures of reading literature and to interpretative approaches to literature. It aims to provide students with competence in critical thinking and practice in close reading and analysis, knowledge of the formal characteristics of each genre, and an appreciation of literary excellence. Readings include a variety of short stories, poems, and plays selected from a wide range of British, American, and World literature. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 222	Introduction to Language	3(3,0)
This survey course examines current theoretical and applied areas of linguistics, including the different levels of structure, the nature of language acquisition, language variation and evolution, and language teaching. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 223	Introduction to Drama	3(3,0)
In this course, you will explore what drama is, its basic elements, and the evolution of its dramatic structure over centuries. You will study selected and representative plays from different periods that will help you broaden your understanding and appreciation of literature. The course also aims to develop your critical thinking and analysis, and encourages you to respond critically to dramatic works through well-developed oral and written criticism.		

ENGL 230	Shakespeare's Plays	3(3,0)
Students study Shakespeare's representative comedies, histories, and tragedies in this course. The plays are read intensively and understood in the context of the period's theatrical conventions, the culture of play in early modern England, and the period's social, cultural, religious, and intellectual history. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 235	Creative Writing	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the process and practice of imaginative writing. Students will read works of fiction, creative non-fiction, and poetry and learn writing techniques in those genres. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 252	Introduction to American Literature	3(3,0)
This course explores the works of major literary figures and authors representing different literary schools from the sixteenth century to modern times. Students will closely examine selected texts as literary achievements and situate them within the historical context and framework of American culture. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 300	Introduction to World Literature	3(3,0)
The course surveys selected works in English or in translation from non-Anglo-American cultural traditions. Texts can be drawn from African, Asian, European, Latin American, and Middle Eastern literature, with a focus on their historical and cultural contexts. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 330	Language Acquisition	3(3,0)
This course will survey theories of language acquisition. It will address human language processing, learners' motivational factors, and contextual factors that influence language learning. It will uncover the principles of first- and second-language acquisition. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

FADR 215	History of Art	3(3,0)
This course explores the major forms of artistic expression from the ancient world to the present, from various cultural perspectives. Students learn to examine and analyze		

works of art in their historical context and to articulate what they see or experience in a meaningful way. This course covers the pre-Renaissance, Renaissance, and post-Renaissance periods, as well as the rich layers of 19th- and 20th-century modern art up to the present day.

GRDS 230	Photography I	3(2,2)
This course teaches students the basics of black-and-white digital photography. It is a lecture-based course with extensive hands-on practical training. Students learn how to develop an eye for photography and for framing objects. They also enhance their knowledge of the different parts of a camera and the mechanisms of film printing and development while continuously scanning other photographers' work in contemporary and historical scenes.		

HIST 210	History of England	3(3,0)
This broad survey course provides a narrative of British history from 1066, including political, social, and cultural developments. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

HIST 350	History of the Arabs in the Classical Period	3(3,0)
This is an elective course whose primary objectives are to familiarize students with the history of the Arab peoples. The course's emphasis will be on explaining the early Arab conquests of Bilad al-Sham, Egypt, Persia, and North Africa; the internal civil strife within the early Muslim community; the emergence and development of the Umayyad caliphate; and the emergence and development of the Abbasid Empire.		

HIST 360	Contemporary History	3(3,0)
This is an elective course whose major objectives are to familiarize students with contemporary issues and to enhance their understanding from historical and cultural perspectives. Co-requisite: ENGL 210.		

HIST 365	History of Europe in the Middle East	3(3,0)
This course examines the ties between Europe and the Middle East in the 19th and 20th centuries, focusing on the reaction of Middle Eastern societies to European intervention and influence. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

HIST 370	The Economic and Social History of the Middle East	3(3,0)
This elective course aims to familiarize students with key events that shaped the evolution of social and economic developments in the Middle East, enhancing their understanding of the historical and economic dimensions of these developments. **Co-requisite:** ENGL 210.		

HIST 480	Special Topics in History	3(3,0)
This course provides an in-depth look at selected issues related to historical events across ages and stages of development. Current issues related to historical events		

across ages and development are thoroughly explored through readings, research, discussion, and guest lectures. Prerequisite: Consent of the instructor.

MUSC 201	Introduction to Music	3(3,0)
This introductory music appreciation course is intended for students who wish to broaden their knowledge of music. It addresses the basics of music theory and history. Students learn to listen to and analyze music and to apply these skills to musical masterpieces across various styles, including classical, romantic, flamenco, blues, and jazz. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 101.		

MUSC 301	Introduction to the World of Western and Arabic Music: Theory and Practice	3(3,0)
Music is considered one of the essential humanities courses at most Universities worldwide. This course will cover a brief historical review of Western and Arabic music; the Art of listening to music; important musical terminology; fundamentals of tuning and pitch frequencies in Western and Arabic music; the seven most important elements of music: Rhythm, Melody, Harmony, Timbre, Dynamics, Texture, and Form; the technical interference behind the development of Western and Arabic musical scale-structures; introduction to reading Western and Arabic sheet music; Chords structure, Chords progress, and Arpeggios; the use of the guitar in the Arabic music.		

PHIL 301	Major Trends in Philosophy	3(3,0)
This is a study of some major topics in philosophy. The course emphasizes theory of knowledge, theory of mind, determinism and free will, and morality and ethical values. Along with some assigned readings, students will watch movies whose analysis will help them better comprehend the course content. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

PHIL 303	Introduction to Ethics	3(3,0)
People often wonder about what makes for good ways to live and the right ways to act. They also speculate about the best way of life, what action is right, and what authority moral claims have over us. The course introduces students to the major moral theories and thinkers addressing these questions. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

PHIL 307	Business Ethics	3(3,0)
This course introduces contemporary philosophical thinking on ethical issues in business. Students will be exposed to important ethical issues they might face, asked to give sound ethical judgment to problems they might face in their line of work, helped to become armed with a set of codes that will prepare them to confront and resolve ethical dilemmas they might encounter at work, and enabled to apply the techniques for analyzing and resolving ethical problems when they arise. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210.		

PHIL 310	Philosophers of Peace	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to peacebuilding and conflict prevention by examining the main theories on peace and security. It examines the ideas of Thucydides, Aristotle,		